We learned the relevant data structures and naming conventions for tables, classes, columns, attributes, IDs, and relationships. We saw how to create, read, update, and delete this data. Finally, we now understand how transactions and callbacks can be used to prevent inconsistent changes.

This, coupled with validation as described in Chapter 7, *Task B: Validation and Unit Testing*, covers all the essentials of Active Record that every Rails programmer needs to know. If you have specific needs beyond what is covered here, look to the Rails Guides[156] for more information.

The next major subsystem to cover is Action Pack, which covers both the view and controller portions of Rails.

Footnotes

[152] https://github.com/rails/acts_as_list

[153] http://guides.rubyonrails.org/security.html#sql-injection

[154] http://api.rubyonrails.org/classes/ActiveRecord/Callbacks.html#label-Types+of+callbacks

[155] https://api.rubyonrails.org/classes/ActiveSupport/Concern.html

[156] http://guides.rubyonrails.org/

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